

Minutes | Executive Committee

2nd Meeting of the 2026-2027 Executive Committee

May 24th 2026 | 10:30 AM EST

Online meetings held via video conference held via Zoom

Hybrid and in-person meetings held in the Student Commons, 230 College Street, Toronto, ON

Unless otherwise specified, meetings are held in open session.

INVITED / PRESENT		
Name	Title	In attendance
Executive Committee		
Marie Kinderman ▾	President	Present ▾
Tony Guo ▾	VP of Finance and Operations	Present ▾
Nadège Jackiw ▾	VP of Public & University Affairs	Present ▾
Verona Odhiambo ▾	VP of Student Life	Present ▾
Juan Diego Areiza ▾	VP of Equity	Present ▾
Johnny Dong ▾	VP of Professional Faculties	Present ▾
Staff, Members, Visitors and Non-voting		
Ankit Sharma	General Manager (ex-officio)	Regrets with Remorse ▾

Late items submitted to appear on the agenda are marked in red in case the committee wishes to amend the agenda to exclude them.

MINUTES**1. Call to Order**

This meeting is called to order at 10:55am.

2. Approval of the Agenda**RESOLUTION**

Moved: *Guo* (*VP FO*) Seconded: *Kinderman* (*President*)

BE IT RESOLVED that the agenda be approved as presented.

VOTING RESULT: **UNANIMOUSLY CARRIED**

3. Motion to Join the University of Toronto Transit Coalition

RESOLUTION

Moved: Jackiw ▾ (VP PF ▾)

Seconded: Odhiambo ▾ (VP PUA ▾)

WHEREAS the University of Toronto Graduate Students' Union has proposed re-establishing the University of Toronto Transit Coalition in partnership with student organizations and transit advocacy groups, including Rocket Riders, to advocate for improved student transit affordability and accessibility; and

WHEREAS participation in the Coalition would provide the Executive Committee with an opportunity to collaborate on transit advocacy initiatives while retaining discretion regarding future involvement in specific campaigns or actions;

BE IT RESOLVED that the Executive Committee approve joining the re-established University of Toronto Transit Coalition for the purpose of participating in discussion and collaborative advocacy regarding student transit affordability and accessibility; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Executive Committee appoint a representative to attend Coalition meetings and report back on proposed transit advocacy initiatives and opportunities for collaboration.

VOTING RESULT: **UNANIMOUSLY CARRIED ▾**

SUMMARY: Committee is interested in this project. Committee will find an avenue to extend this invite to anyone interested in joining this issue.



4. Motion to Add the UTSU Land Acknowledgement to the UTSU Website

RESOLUTION

Moved: Jackiw ▾ (VP PUA ▾)

Seconded: Guo ▾ (VP FO ▾)

WHEREAS the University of Toronto Students' Union recognizes the importance of acknowledging the Indigenous peoples and nations whose traditional lands the University of Toronto occupies; and

WHEREAS the UTSU website is a primary public-facing platform that should reflect the organization's commitments and values;

BE IT RESOLVED that the Executive Committee direct the appropriate staff and executives to add an official UTSU Land Acknowledgement to the UTSU website in a visible and accessible location.

VOTING RESULT: **UNANIMOUSLY CARRIED ▾**

5. Retroactive approval for the Aurélie Etienne Petition

RESOLUTION

Moved: Guo ▾ (VP FO ▾)

Seconded: Areiza ▾ (VP Equity ▾)

WHEREAS the UTSU has been asked to sign a petition supporting the release of Hamza Ahmed Khan, a UofT graduate student that has been abducted and detained in Pakistan while conducting their dissertation fieldwork;

BE IT RESOLVED that the Executive Committee sign on in supporting this petition (app A).

VOTING RESULT: **UNANIMOUSLY CARRIED ▾**

6. Motion to help revamp the Little Free Library**RESOLUTION**Moved: Kinderman ▾ (*President* ▾) Seconded: Guo ▾ (*VP FO* ▾)

WHEREAS the University of Toronto “Provost’s office recently confirmed that the University intends to increase tuition this fall” (see. appendix B),

WHEREAS the UTSU has a mission statement that aligns with speaking against fee raises in principle;

BE IT RESOLVED that the UTSU signed in support of the letter addressed to the Governing Council pushing against fee increases.

VOTING RESULT: **UNANIMOUSLY CARRIED** ▾**7. Motion for PASA to receive funding from the UTSU Executive Initiative Fund.****RESOLUTION**Moved: Dong ▾ (*VP FO* ▾) Seconded: Jackiw ▾ (*VP PUA* ▾)

WHEREAS the Physician Assistant Student Association (PASA) is composed of physician assistant students whose program structure composes of a single month in-person; and

WHEREAS PASA currently does not have any sources of funding as to provide programming to its students; and

WHEREAS the 2027 Year 1 PASA class is looking to gain funding to pay for a collective tutor which would be immensely beneficial due to the programs fast paced structure;

BE IT RESOLVED that the UTSU Exec Committee commit to providing funds amounting to no more than \$2500 dollars to PASA from the Executive Initiatives fund provided that the expenses are spent in accordance with the proposal provided by PASA; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the UTSU Executive Committee commit to working alongside PASA to assist in securing funding for future years



VOTING RESULT: **UNANIMOUSLY CARRIED** ▾

SUMMARY: A total of \$1500 dollars will be allocated to PASA, with \$500 from the Clubs Funding Budget through a 2025-2026 retroactive registration and \$1000 from the executive initiative fund. They are encouraged to register for Clubs funding this year.

8. Motion for funding for the KPEUA Event.

RESOLUTION

Moved: Dong ▾ (VP PF ▾)

Seconded: Odhiambo ▾ (VP SL ▾)

WHEREAS the Kinesiology & Physical Education Undergraduate Association is looking to obtain funding for their graduate formal; and

WHEREAS due to ticket sales not reaching the level to fully offset expenses;

BE IT RESOLVED that the UTSU commit to covering a portion of the expenses **PROVIDED** that the KPEUA first attempt to obtain funding from the Faculty of Kinesiology & Physical Education;

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the UTSU give discretion to the VPFO, VPSL, VPPF as a collective to come to a funding number no more than \$5000 dollars;

BE IT FINALLY RESOLVED that the final funding decision be reported upon at the next possible executive committee meeting once finalized.

VOTING RESULT: **UNANIMOUSLY CARRIED** ▾

9. Motion for UTSU Participation within the EngSoc Flrosh Week Campus Tours**RESOLUTION**

Moved: Dong ▾ (VP FO ▾)

Seconded: Jackiw ▾ (VP PUA ▾)

WHEREAS the Engineering Society runs a campus tour during their orientation week comprised of important spots and clubs on campus for engineering students; and

WHEREAS the Engineering orientation subcommittee is currently planning this year's programming for the tour and looking for groups interested in being apart of the tour

BE IT RESOLVED that the UTSU expresses their interest in participating in the EngSoc Flrosh Week Campus Tours so as to better connect with their engineering constituents.

VOTING RESULT: **UNANIMOUSLY CARRIED ▾**

SUMMARY: Committee interest noted. Action item for the next agenda.

10. Motion for UTSU approval of the participation of engineering clubs within the UTSU Clubs Fair for the 2026/2027 Orientation**RESOLUTION**

Moved: Dong ▾ (VP PF ▾)

Seconded: Areiza ▾ (VP Equity ▾)

WHEREAS engineering clubs have traditionally not been allowed to participate in clubs fair due to not qualifying as an UTSU registered club, and

WHEREAS this divide in membership has caused a disconnect between engineering and other faculties and college, and

WHEREAS by allowing engineering clubs into the UTSU Clubs Fair, we encourage greater cohesiveness between these two communities while also providing opportunities for students on both sides to join clubs previously “off-limits” to them;

BE IT RESOLVED that the UTSU allows the participation of a limited number of engineering clubs in the UTSU Clubs Fair for the 2026/2027 Orientation Cycle

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the UTSU Clubs Fair shall be composed of no more than a proportional representation of engineering clubs for the 2026/2027 Orientation Cycle

BE IT FINALLY RESOLVED that the UTSU look into the possibility of signing a Memorandum of Understanding with EngSoc to allow the future participation of engineering clubs within the UTSU Club Fair

VOTING RESULT: **UNANIMOUSLY CARRIED ▾**

SUMMARY: Questions about UTSU Club Fair x EngSoc Club Fair’s mutual independence have been raised. Despite appearing to be engineer/art-sci-exclusive, membership to clubs are not defined explicitly as disallowing ArtSci members to join EngSoc clubs, and vice-versa. The committee action item is to include a pathway for EngSoc to have clubs at UTSU Club Fairs, and encourage the promotion of cross-faculty clubs membership.

11. Motion for Informal Discussion regarding Governance Training

RESOLUTION

Moved: Kinderman ▾ (*President* ▾) Seconded: Areiza ▾ (*VP Equity* ▾)

WHEREAS the UTGSU planned a tri-campus UofT governance training for the central students' unions, including UofT (see appendix b);

BE IT RESOLVED that UTSU executives and the general manager strongly consider participating in a training the week of June 16th when other parties are available

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED the UTSU help host by booking a meeting room like 544 which accommodates many people and would help elevate the event and our participation in tri-campus discussion and organizing.

VOTING RESULT: **UNANIMOUSLY CARRIED** ▾

SUMMARY: Training will cover how the Governing Council works and their administration workflows. Committee interest noted, action item: look into if the UTSU can host or provide space. June 16th is our proposed date

12. Motion for Informal Discussion regarding the Website Revamp.**RESOLUTION**Moved: Kinderman ▾ (*President* ▾) Seconded: Areiza ▾ (*VP Equity* ▾)**WHEREAS** the UTSU website has remained out of date for many years, and**WHEREAS** Community Resource Specialists have been tasked with outlining website updates independently without organization-wide collaboration and action regarding website content and formatting, and**WHEREAS** the Outreach and Engagement team has demonstrated commitment to a full website revamp and revival;**BE IT RESOLVED** that the Executive Team play an instrumental role in providing recommendations for this website in full accordance with the Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act, with visually engaging and attractive graphics, that is representative of our constituents and easy to navigate, and a well organized structure that can be amended and adopted for years to come, and**BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED** that these changes occur alongside updates to the Branding Guidelines of the organization.VOTING RESULT: **UNANIMOUSLY CARRIED** ▾**SUMMARY:** O+E and the Executive Committee have formed a working committee to discuss revamping the website. This committee has an open-invite. Everyone is encouraged to join. Discussion as to whether an external contractor is required, response about the UTSU's internal knowledge/ability to build it ourselves.



13. Motion for responding to the Hart House Capital Levy

RESOLUTION

Moved: Kinderman (President) Seconded: Areiza (VP Equity)

WHEREAS Hart House has planned extensive, long-term renovations to their building; and

WHEREAS they have sought sizeable funding for these renovations from the student population at a time of financial instability due to Bill 33; and

WHEREAS Hart House is proposing a referendum to establish a Hart House Capital Fee Levy to the tune of \$60 per term for full-time undergraduates (see appendix c);

BE IT RESOLVED that the UTSU Executive Committee develop a strategy for opposing this dramatic fee increase at a time of Bill 33 instability and without proper consultation with the student population, and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that during this referendum election we encourage students to vote NO on this measure and publicize our stance.

VOTING RESULT: **UNANIMOUSLY CARRIED**

VOTER SPLIT: YEAS 5, NAY 0 ABSTAIN: 1

SUMMARY: The Committee raises concerns about the fee amount, fee schedule for ten years, and the seemingly lack of consultation with the students. The Committee seeks to gain clarification as to whether this levy is subsidizing the HartHouse's ability to run private events over student events.

14. Motion for UTSU Food Programming.**RESOLUTION**Moved: Kinderman ▾ (*President* ▾) Seconded: Guo ▾ (*VP FO* ▾)

WHEREAS the UTSU runs many forms of food programming and works with many organizations on food initiatives; and

WHEREAS the context of these initiatives is evolving due to the Food Bank renovation and progress with the Grocery Coop initiative (see appendix d); and

WHEREAS the Food Coalition is also seeking office space in the building and extended supports (see appendix e);

BE IT RESOLVED the Exec Team along with Programs & Services and Operations help facilitate conversation between these three orgs all helping alleviate food insecurity, and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED this communication and future guidelines help clarify differences between these food supports to students seeking them and builds solidarity and camaraderie instead of competition

VOTING RESULT: **UNANIMOUSLY CARRIED** ▾

SUMMARY: The President discloses a previous relationship with Regenesi, and commits to recusing themselves from any voting decisions. Open working meeting invite extended.



15. Motion regarding Promoting Volunteer and Work Opportunities.

RESOLUTION

Moved: Kinderman ▾ (*President* ▾) Seconded: Areiza ▾ (*VP Equity* ▾)

WHEREAS the UTSU has a Work & Volunteer page on their website and also promotes job opportunities on their Instagram; and

WHEREAS the President and other team members have expressed their interest in promoting wider opportunities and in more thorough fashion;

BE IT RESOLVED that the UTSU promote community volunteer and work opportunities on their website and Instagram, such as volunteering for the pedestrianization pilot in the Church Wellesley Village (see appendix f), an area where many students live and spend their time

VOTING RESULT: **UNANIMOUSLY CARRIED** ▾

SUMMARY: The UTSU should use cross-promotion to build it's brand presence. Concerns about quality over quantity, and dilution of impact. Preference about stories noted.

16. Motion regarding Events & Programs Documentation & Sharing

RESOLUTION

Moved: Kinderman ▾ (*President* ▾) Seconded: Odhiambo ▾ (*VP SL* ▾)**WHEREAS** the UTSU runs various programs and hosts events throughout the year, and**WHEREAS** the Outreach and Engagement team is designed to help document and promote those programs and events; and**WHEREAS** there is a stark lack of awareness of UTSU programming for students and inadequate professional coverage and successful promotion of programs and events;**BE IT RESOLVED** that the Executives work with the Outreach and Engagement team, their photographer Peter in the UofT Flash Photography Club, and CRS to ensure events & programs are promoted, documented and shared in systematic fashion**BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED** that programs and events are promoted digitally through multiple means and through poster and that programs are promoted in a visually appealing manner on a regular basisVOTING RESULT: **UNANIMOUSLY CARRIED** ▾**17. Adjournment****With no further business to consider, the meeting shall be adjourned.**

The meeting adjourned at 11:50 am on May 24th, 2026.